

How to enable autologin on Parrot Security OS / Kali Linux

The objective of this short guide is to explain how to enable autologin on Parrot Security OS / Kali Linux with step by step instructions.

In this tutorial you will learn:

- How to identify what is your system's default Display Manager.
- How to edit an appropriate configuration file to enable autologin on Parrot Sec OS / Kali Linux.

Parrot Sec OS / Kali Linux autologin configuration

Software Requirements and Conventions Used

Software Requirements and Linux Command Line Conventions

Category	Requirements, Conventions or Software Version Used
System	Parrot Sec OS / Kali Linux
Software	N/A
Other	Privileged access to your Linux system as root or via the <code>sudo</code> command.
Conventions	<code>#</code> - requires given linux commands to be executed with root privileges either directly as a root user or by use of <code>sudo</code> command <code>\$</code> - requires given linux commands to be executed as a regular non-privileged user

How to enable autologin on Parrot Sec OS / Kali Linux step by step instructions

How to Enable autologin in LightDM

Identify the default Display Manager.

Step 1 First confirm which display manager your Parrot Sec / Kali Linux is set to use as a default display manager:

```
# cat /etc/X11/default-display-manager
/usr/sbin/lightdm
```

Step 2 Next, edit `/etc/lightdm/lightdm.conf` configuration file and uncomment the following two lines by removing the `#` in front of each line & add your username & timeout:

```
autologin-user=<username>
autologin-user-timeout=<0>
```

Step 3 Once you have made the above change simply reboot your Parrot OS /Kali Linux to confirm your configuration.

```
# reboot
```

***NOTE* - Your Linux system may have a different display manager than lightdm (depending on the desktop environment). so the instructions to autologin on a different display manager will be a little different, so research online for instructions on your specific display manager. **You can also install different display managers and choose which one to use**

gdm3, kdm, and lightdm are all [display managers](#). They provide graphical logins and handle user authentication.

From a Wiki article,:

A display manager presents the user with a login screen. A session starts when a user successfully enters a valid combination of username and password.

GNOME Display Manager (gdm3)

gdm3 is the successor of gdm which was the GNOME display manager. The newer gdm3 uses a minimal version of gnome-shell, and provides the same look and feel of as GNOME3 session. Is the Canonical choice since Ubuntu 17.10. You can install it with:

```
sudo apt-get install gdm3
```

and remove it with:

```
sudo apt-get remove gdm3
```

KDE Display Manager (kdm)

kdm was KDE's display manager. But it's been deprecated in KDE5 in favor of SDDM, which is more capable as a display manager, and hence comes by default with Kubuntu. You can install it with:

```
sudo apt-get install sddm
```

and remove it with:

```
sudo apt-get remove sddm
```

LightDM

LightDM was Canonical's solution for a display manager. It was supposed to be lightweight and comes by default with Ubuntu (until 17.04), Xubuntu, and Lubuntu. It's configurable, with various greeter themes available.

You can install it with:

```
sudo apt-get install lightdm
```

And remove it with:

```
sudo apt-get remove lightdm
```

Repairing is broad term. However, if you have multiple display managers installed, you can choose between them using:

```
sudo dpkg-reconfigure <display manager name>
```

example:

```
sudo dpkg-reconfigure gdm3      or      sudo dpkg-reconfigure lightdm
```

You can use any display manager's name in place of gdm3 in the above command, and it will allow you to choose between them. You must reboot for the change to take affect.

To check which display manager is currently being used, run this command:

```
cat /etc/X11/default-display-manager
```